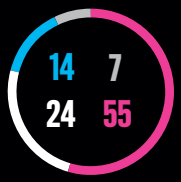
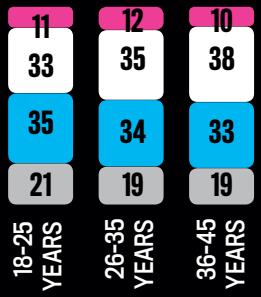
WHAT'S YOUR FAVOURITE FORM OF FOREPLAY?



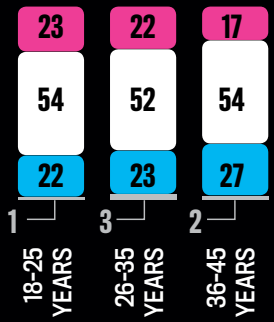
● Kissing ● Caressing
● Love talk
● Watching porn

HOW LONG DO YOU SPEND ON FOREPLAY?



● Less than 5 min
● 5-10 min ● 10-15 min
● More than 15 min

FOR HOW LONG DO YOU MAKE LOVE?



● Up to 45 minutes
● Up to 30 minutes
● Approx. 15 minutes
● Less

THE YOUNG SPEND MORE TIME ON BOTH FOREPLAY AND SEX

of virginity. A majority (54 per cent) of those between 18 and 25 years say virginity is not important to them and 46 per cent say that it is. But the attitude reverses when it comes to those older than 25—52.5 per cent of those from 26 to 35 years and 57.5 per cent of those between 36 and 45 years say virginity does matter to them. Interestingly, respondents from smaller towns are more liberal regarding virginity—92 per cent from Indore, 63 per cent from Chandigarh, 61 per cent from Bhubaneswar, 50 per cent from Ahmedabad and 62 per cent from Pune say they don't care about it.

There is, however, consensus across age groups when it comes to what is the biggest turn-on, with a majority saying it is love talk, followed by foreplay. The favourite sex position (man on top) and favourite form of foreplay (kissing) also remain consistent across age groups. And while oral sex is the most common form of sexual experimentation across ages, more people under the age of 25 have tried out phone sex. "The digital age has had a great impact on how young people view sex and relationships. Since they are exposed to it almost everywhere from a very young age, it does not matter to them as much as it would to someone who hasn't grown up watching OTT, TV shows, movies, songs and video games where sexual suggestiveness is the norm," explains Dr Harish Shetty, a Mumbai-based psychiatrist.

The young also seem to have more time for sex. A majority (35 per cent) of those between 18 and 25 years spend 10 to 15 minutes on foreplay, followed by 20 per cent saying they spend more than 15 minutes on it. When it comes to those between 36 and 45 years, a majority (38 per cent) say they spend 5 to 10 minutes on foreplay. Similarly, those who spend up to 45 minutes having sex are primarily the young, with 23.4 per cent in the 18 to 25 year age group saying they do so and 17.5 per cent of those between 36 and 45 saying the same. While 34 per cent of those under 25 say they can have sex any time of the day, only 22 per cent of those above 36 say the same, with the latter mostly preferring to have sex at night (70 per cent).

There are other signs of change too. Among those who identify as homosexuals, 60 per cent say they have had sex with a homosexual partner. While the decriminalisation of homosexuality in 2018 has helped, some say there is also a marginal increase in acceptance due to portrayals of homosexuals in popular media. "Compared to pre-2018, there is far more ease of dating today in a city like Delhi. I can't comment on smaller towns. Gay-friendly dating apps have also helped improve our chances to find a partner, but I would still not openly kiss on the road or speak to the media as a gay man and we still need to strive for such a day to come," says Anurag Seth *(name*

Graphics by TANMOY CHAKRABORTY; *Illustration by* SIDDHANT JUMDE

